

Caleb H. Kelley, Ph.D.

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Last updated: March 2026

🎓 EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Romance Languages

August 2017 – August 2024

The University of Alabama

Tuscaloosa, AL

- **Dissertation:** *Sounding gay and straight in Seville: A variationist perspective on persona and syllable-final /s/ realization*
- **Advisor:** Dr. Erin O'Rourke

M.A. in Romance Languages

August 2015 – May 2017

The University of Alabama

Tuscaloosa, AL

B.A. in Spanish

August 2010 – December 2013

University of Alabama at Birmingham

Birmingham, AL

B.S. in Biology

August 2010 – December 2013

University of Alabama at Birmingham

Birmingham, AL

🔍 RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research examines how speakers use phonetic variation to construct and interpret socially meaningful personae in Spanish-speaking contexts, drawing on acoustic analysis, perception experiments, and computational modeling within a sociophonetic and third-wave variationist framework.

Keywords: Hispanic linguistics; phonetics and phonology; sociolinguistics; language variation and change; dialectology; quantitative/experimental methodology; sociophonetic perception; second language acquisition; listener interpretation; language attitudes and ideologies; educational technology

💼 EMPLOYMENT

Visiting Assistant Professor

2024 – present

Department of Spanish and Portuguese, Emory University

Atlanta, GA

Graduate Teaching Assistant/Instructor of Record

2015 – 2024

Department of Modern Languages and Classics, The University of Alabama

Tuscaloosa, AL

PUBLICATIONS

Manuscripts in Preparation

Kelley, C. H. Vowel space and performed identity in male Sevillian speech. Manuscript in preparation for submission to *Spanish in Context*.

Kelley, C. H. Prosodic identity performance in Sevillian Spanish: A mixed-effects analysis of gay and straight vocal personae. Manuscript in preparation for submission to *Journal of Language and Sexuality*.

RESEARCH PROJECTS IN PROGRESS

Sociophonetic Perception of Sexual Identity: Evidence From Native and Non-Native Spanish Speakers

- IRB approved Spanish/English Bilingual perception experiment using matched guise methodology
- Data collection phase: Spring 2026

Supervised classification of sociophonetic identity markers in Sevillian Spanish persona production

- Applying random forest and SVM classification to acoustic features (spectral moments, F0 contours, vowel formant values) extracted from a controlled persona-switching corpus
- Investigating which segmental and prosodic features most reliably predict performed vocal personae

PRESENTATIONS

Invited Talks

Spring 2026. *From Production to Perception: Designing a Sociophonetic Study*, Department of Modern Languages and Classics, The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.

Fall 2020. *Phonetics and Phonology Session* (Invited), SP 383: Linguistic Fundamentals of the Spanish Language, Tuscaloosa, AL.

Peer Reviewed Conference Presentations

Kelley, C. H. (forthcoming). Modeling prosodic variation in Spanish gay and straight personae. *Southeastern Conference on Linguistics (SECOL) 2026*, Georgia State University, Atlanta, GA.

Kelley, C. H. (2024). Phonetic dimensions of gay-sounding speech in Spanish: Syllable-final /s/ variation and persona performance. *Linguistics Conference at the University of Georgia (LCUGA) 2024*, University of Georgia, Athens, GA.

Kelley, C. H. (2023). Analyzing the phonetic performance of male sexuality in Sevillian Spanish through remote data collection. *New Ways of Analyzing Variation (NWAV) 51*, Queens College, Flushing, NY.

Kelley, C. H. (2023). Analyzing the performance of male sexuality in Spanish through remote data collection and digital corpus analysis. *Congreso Internacional de Lingüística Digital (CILiDi) 2*, Universidad de Alicante, Alicante, Spain.

- Kelley, C. H.** (2023). Syllable-final /s/ and the sociolinguistic construction of personae in Spanish speakers. *OSU Congress on Hispanic and Lusophone Linguistics Symposium (OSUCHiLL) 27*, The Ohio State University, Columbus, OH (Virtual).
- Kelley, C. H.** (2023). Using sociolinguistic personae to analyze phonetic variation among gay and non-gay Spanish speakers. *University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC)*, The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.
- Kelley, C. H.** (2022). A pilot study investigating sociophonetic variation among LGBTQ+ speakers in Peninsular Spanish. *University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC)*, The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.
- Kelley, C. H.** (2021). Sounding queer in Spain: A sociophonetic analysis of production and perception. *Lavender Languages & Linguistics 27*, California Institute of Integral Studies, San Francisco, CA (Virtual).
- Kelley, C. H.** (2020). Sounding gay and straight in Granada, Spain: Sociophonetic evidence from production and perception. *Lavender Languages & Linguistics 27*, California Institute of Integral Studies, San Francisco, CA (Postponed due to COVID-19).
- Jacobson, S., & **Kelley, C. H.** (2020). Very? Much!: A corpus analysis of alternation between “muy” and “mucho” in Spanish. *10th International Workshop on Spanish Sociolinguistics*, Georgia Institute of Technology, Atlanta, GA (Canceled due to COVID-19).
- Jacobson, S., & **Kelley, C. H.** (2017). “To be” or “to not be”: Attitudes and behaviors toward the split infinitive in English. *8th International Contrastive Linguistics Conference*, National and Kapodistrian University of Athens, Athens, Greece.
- Kelley, C. H.** (2016). The Madre María de San José (1656–1719) Project. *Digitarium: University of Alabama Digital Humanities Conference*, The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.
- Kelley, C. H.** (2016). Null and overt subject pronouns in Madrid and Caracas with verbs of external activity: A corpus study. *Linguistics Conference at the University of Georgia (LCUGA) 3*, University of Georgia, Athens, GA.

Peer Reviewed Poster Presentations

- Kelley, C. H.** (2025). Prosodic identity performance in Spanish: A mixed-effects analysis of gay and straight vocal personae. *Hispanic Linguistics Symposium (HLS) 2025*, University of Arizona, Tucson, AZ [accepted].
- Kelley, C. H.** (2022). Performing sexual orientation in Spanish: A pilot study investigating persona and syllable-final /s/ realization. *10th Workshop on Spanish Sociolinguistics (WSS10)*, University of Georgia, Athens, GA (Virtual).
- Kelley, C. H.** (2016). Null and overt subject pronouns in Madrid and Caracas with verbs of external activity: A corpus study. *Quantitative Methods in Linguistics Research Showcase*, The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.

FUNDING

Research Support

Research support awards (4)

2021 – 2024

\$2,025 total, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics

Conference Travel

Conference funding and travel awards (6)

2017 – 2023

\$4,262 total, UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics; UA Capstone International

External Applications

Lewis and Clark Fund for Exploration and Field Research

2022, 2023

American Philosophical Society (not funded)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

At Emory University

Visiting Assistant Professor

2024 – present

SPAN 101, 102, 201, 202, 212

At The University of Alabama

Graduate Instructor of Record

2015 – 2024

SP 101, 102, 103, 201, 202, 353, 356 (including online sections)

Course Design Collaboration with Dr. Bryan Koronkiewicz

SP 383: Linguistic Fundamentals of the Spanish Language

At University of Montevallo

Adjunct Instructor

2021 – 2022

SPN 101, 102, 201

SERVICE

To the Profession

Linguistic Society of America Committee on LGBTQ+ [Z] Issues in Linguistics (COZIL)

2023 – present

Member

Abstract Reviewer

2017 – 2022

University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC)

To the Department and University

Spanish 102 Coordinator 2020 – 2022
Spanish Basic Language Program, Department of Modern Languages and Classics, UA (43 sections)

Graduate Student Representative 2021 – 2022
Department of Modern Languages and Classics, UA

LengUA Lab Graduate Student Co-director 2020 – 2021
UA (Linguistics research group)

LengUA Lab Member 2016 – 2024
UA

Conference Organization

Committee Member, UALC 2021 – 2022
University of Alabama Languages Conference

IT Committee Member, UALC 2020 – 2021
University of Alabama Languages Conference

Registration Chair, UALC 2018 – 2019
University of Alabama Languages Conference

Vice President/Program Chair, UALC 2017 – 2018
University of Alabama Languages Conference

Student Organizations and Community Outreach

Vice President, La Última Letra 2018 – 2019
UA

Secretary, La Última Letra 2016 – 2017
UA

Event Judge, Convención de la Federación de los Círculos de Español de Alabama 2015 – 2020

Mentoring

Jim Moore Spring 2021
Team teaching assistant and mentee for SP 102 course, UA

Katie Cauley Fall 2020
Team teaching assistant and mentee for SP 102 course, UA

Jordyn Battistelli Fall 2019
Team teaching assistant and mentee for SP 201 course, UA

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Dissertation Summer Writing Challenge, The University of Alabama. Summer 2022.

David Bauer Grant Writing Workshop, The University of Alabama. Fall 2021.

Writing for Academic Publication, Advanced Seminar (CSE 690), The University of Alabama. Spring 2019.

Online Teaching Certification, The University of Alabama. 2016 – 2024.

Spanish Language Immersion Program, Middlebury Language Schools, Middlebury, VT. Summer 2014.

Study Abroad in Jaén, Spain, University of Alabama at Birmingham and Universidad de Jaén. Summer 2011.

MEMBERSHIPS, LANGUAGES, & TECHNICAL SKILLS

Memberships Linguistics Society of America (LSA) • Acoustical Society of America (ASA) • Alabama World Languages Association (AWLA) • Sigma Delta Pi (Omicron Mu Chapter)

Languages English (native) • Spanish (near-native) • French (intermediate)

Programming R • Python • HTML/CSS • $\text{\LaTeX}$ • Bash/Unix • PRAAT

Software Microsoft Office 365 • Adobe Creative Suite • Qualtrics • RStudio • SPSS • PRAAT • Audacity • Montreal Forced Aligner • ELAN • Zotero • EndNote

Platforms Canvas • Blackboard • LingroLearning • VHL Central • Google Drive • Box

References available upon request.